


# SQL Part 1 — Free Practice Guide

Anyone can learn — easy! Nothing to install. You only need a web browser.

## Step 1: Open a free online SQL playground

• sqliteonline.com — choose "SQLite" on the left, type in the big box, click Run.
• db-fiddle.com — pick "SQLite" as the database, paste setup on the left, queries on the right, click Run.
• sqlime.org — a simple SQLite editor in the browser; paste and Run.
• sqlbolt.com — free step-by-step interactive lessons for extra practice.

## Step 2: Paste this setup script and click Run

This creates the same "books" table used in the video.

```
CREATE TABLE books (
  id INTEGER PRIMARY KEY,
  title TEXT,
  author TEXT,
  year INTEGER,
  genre TEXT
);

INSERT INTO books (id, title, author, year, genre) VALUES
  (1, 'Harry Potter', 'J.K. Rowling', 1997, 'Fantasy'),
  (2, 'Matilda', 'Roald Dahl', 1988, 'Comedy'),
  (3, 'Wonder', 'R.J. Palacio', 2012, 'Drama'),
  (4, 'The Hobbit', 'J.R.R. Tolkien', 1937, 'Fantasy'),
  (5, 'Holes', 'Louis Sachar', 1998, 'Mystery'),
  (6, 'Charlotte''s Web', 'E.B. White', 1952, 'Classic'),
  (7, 'Dog Man', 'Dav Pilkey', 2016, 'Comedy'),
  (8, 'Coraline', 'Neil Gaiman', 2002, 'Fantasy');
```

## Step 3: Run every query from the video

Clear the box, paste one query at a time, click Run, and compare with the expected result.

### Your first query: SELECT *

```
SELECT * FROM books;
```

Expected result:

id | title | author | year | genre
1 | Harry Potter | J.K. Rowling | 1997 | Fantasy
2 | Matilda | Roald Dahl | 1988 | Comedy
3 | Wonder | R.J. Palacio | 2012 | Drama
4 | The Hobbit | J.R.R. Tolkien | 1937 | Fantasy
5 | Holes | Louis Sachar | 1998 | Mystery
6 | Charlotte's Web | E.B. White | 1952 | Classic
7 | Dog Man | Dav Pilkey | 2016 | Comedy
8 | Coraline | Neil Gaiman | 2002 | Fantasy

## Pick columns: SELECT title, author

```
SELECT title, author FROM books;
```

Expected result:
title | author
Harry Potter | J.K. Rowling
Matilda | Roald Dahl
Wonder | R.J. Palacio
The Hobbit | J.R.R. Tolkien
Holes | Louis Sachar
Charlotte's Web | E.B. White
Dog Man | Dav Pilkey
Coraline | Neil Gaiman

## WHERE with = (equals)

```
SELECT * FROM books WHERE genre = 'Fantasy';
```

Expected result:
id | title | author | year | genre
1 | Harry Potter | J.K. Rowling | 1997 | Fantasy
4 | The Hobbit | J.R.R. Tolkien | 1937 | Fantasy
8 | Coraline | Neil Gaiman | 2002 | Fantasy

## WHERE with > and <

```
SELECT title, year FROM books WHERE year > 2000;
```

Expected result:
title | year
Wonder | 2012
Dog Man | 2016
Coraline | 2002

## AND: both must be true

```
SELECT title, genre, year FROM books WHERE genre = 'Fantasy' AND year > 1990;
```

Expected result:
title | genre | year
Harry Potter | Fantasy | 1997
Coraline | Fantasy | 2002

## OR: either can be true

```
SELECT title, genre FROM books WHERE genre = 'Comedy' OR genre = 'Mystery';
```

Expected result:
title | genre
Matilda | Comedy
Holes | Mystery
Dog Man | Comedy

## LIKE: search by pattern

```
SELECT title FROM books WHERE title LIKE 'H%';
```

Expected result:

title
Harry Potter
Holes

## ORDER BY ASC / DESC

```
SELECT title, year FROM books ORDER BY year DESC;
```

Expected result:
title | year
Dog Man | 2016
Wonder | 2012
Coraline | 2002
Holes | 1998
Harry Potter | 1997
Matilda | 1988
Charlotte's Web | 1952
The Hobbit | 1937

## LIMIT: top results

```
SELECT title, year FROM books ORDER BY year DESC LIMIT 3;
```

Expected result:
title | year
Dog Man | 2016
Wonder | 2012
Coraline | 2002

## Putting it all together

```
SELECT title, year FROM books WHERE year < 2000 ORDER BY year ASC LIMIT 2;
```

Expected result:
title | year
The Hobbit | 1937
Charlotte's Web | 1952

## Step 4: Practice challenges (try before peeking!)

C1. Two newest Fantasy books (video challenge)

C2. Show only title and year

C3. Books older than 1960

C4. Comedy books written after 2000

C5. Titles containing the word 'man'

C6. All books sorted A to Z by title

C7. The single oldest book

## Answers

### C1. Two newest Fantasy books (video challenge)

```
SELECT title, year FROM books
WHERE genre = 'Fantasy'
ORDER BY year DESC
LIMIT 2;
```

Expected result:
title | year
Coraline | 2002
Harry Potter | 1997

### C2. Show only title and year

```
SELECT title, year FROM books;
```

Expected result:
title | year
Harry Potter | 1997
Matilda | 1988
Wonder | 2012
The Hobbit | 1937
Holes | 1998
Charlotte's Web | 1952
Dog Man | 2016
Coraline | 2002

### C3. Books older than 1960

```
SELECT title, year FROM books
WHERE year < 1960;
```

Expected result:
title | year
The Hobbit | 1937
Charlotte's Web | 1952

### C4. Comedy books written after 2000

```
SELECT title, year FROM books
WHERE genre = 'Comedy' AND year > 2000;
```

Expected result:
title | year
Dog Man | 2016

### C5. Titles containing the word 'man'

```
SELECT title FROM books
WHERE title LIKE '%man%';
```

Expected result:
title
Dog Man

### C6. All books sorted A to Z by title

```
SELECT * FROM books
ORDER BY title ASC;
```

Expected result:
id | title | author | year | genre
6 | Charlotte's Web | E.B. White | 1952 | Classic
8 | Coraline | Neil Gaiman | 2002 | Fantasy
7 | Dog Man | Dav Pilkey | 2016 | Comedy
1 | Harry Potter | J.K. Rowling | 1997 | Fantasy
5 | Holes | Louis Sachar | 1998 | Mystery
2 | Matilda | Roald Dahl | 1988 | Comedy
4 | The Hobbit | J.R.R. Tolkien | 1937 | Fantasy
3 | Wonder | R.J. Palacio | 2012 | Drama

### C7. The single oldest book

```
SELECT title, year FROM books
ORDER BY year ASC
LIMIT 1;
```

Expected result:
title | year
The Hobbit | 1937

## Up next: Part 2

COUNT, SUM, AVG, GROUP BY and HAVING. Link: [PART 2 LINK]